

ELEMENTS OF PROJECT MANAGEMENT

M1 EXAM PREPARATION — COMPLETE ANSWERS

How to write according to Bloom's Taxonomy

- 2 marks: give a precise definition/concept followed by the required key points.
- 3 marks: give the concept, explain the key points, and add an application/example where appropriate.
- Explain: show that you understand the concept rather than only listing keywords.
- Apply/Illustrate: connect the concept to a realistic project situation.
- Analyze: show cause → effect → consequence and, where useful, the project manager's response.
- Compare/Differentiate: use a table for fast, clear comparison.
- Quotation question: Meaning → Project Management concept → Application/example → Result.

PART A — 2-MARK QUESTIONS

Q1. Define Project Management.

Exam-ready answer: Project Management is the application of knowledge, skills and tools to plan, organize and control project activities so that project objectives are achieved within the required time, cost and scope. It involves managing the project from initiation through planning, execution, monitoring and control, and finally closure.

Easy memory: PM = Plan + Organize + Control → achieve the objective.

Bloom/application note: For a short 2-mark answer, the definition plus the project-life-cycle idea is sufficient.

Q2. Explain Triple Constraints.

Exam-ready answer: The three major constraints of project management are: (1) Time — completing the project within the required schedule; (2) Cost — completing it within the allocated budget; and (3) Scope — completing the agreed project requirements. These constraints are interrelated, so a change in one can affect the others. The course material also identifies Quality as an additional constraint.

Easy memory: T–C–S = Time, Cost, Scope. If extra features are added, scope increases and may increase time and cost.

Bloom/application note: The final application sentence moves the answer beyond simple recall.

Q3. What is Project Scope?

Exam-ready answer: Project scope defines what the project has to accomplish and establishes its boundaries, including what is included and excluded from the project. It covers the project deliverables, tasks, deadlines and costs and helps the project team, stakeholders and clients remain aligned with the project objectives.

Easy memory: Scope = What is IN + What is OUT.

Bloom/application note: If asked to explain significance, add that scope helps manage expectations, allocate resources and keep the project on track.

Q4. Differentiate Authority, Responsibility and Accountability.

Exam-ready answer: Authority is the power granted to an individual to make decisions. Responsibility is the obligation to perform assigned work. Accountability means being answerable for the satisfactory completion or result of that work.

Easy memory: Authority = Can decide; Responsibility = Must do; Accountability = Must answer.

Bloom/application note: For a 2-mark comparison, the three one-line meanings are the safest format.

Q5. What are the three organizational structures?

Structure	Meaning	Memory
Functional Organization	Work is organized according to functional departments.	Department
Projectized Organization	The project manager has major authority and the team works directly for the project.	Project Manager
Matrix Organization	Combines functional and projectized structures; members generally report to both a functional manager and a project manager.	Two bosses

Easy memory: Functional = Department; Projectized = PM; Matrix = Two bosses.

Q6. What is a Projectized Organization?

Exam-ready answer: A projectized organization is an organizational structure in which the project manager has major authority and team members work directly for the project. It provides strong communication, quick decision-making and clear project responsibility, but it can also lead to duplication of resources and higher costs.

Easy memory: Projectized = PM has power.

Bloom/application note: The advantages/disadvantages make the answer stronger if the question asks for explanation rather than only definition.

PART B — 3-MARK QUESTIONS

Q1. Explain Project Life Cycle with a suitable example.

Exam-ready answer: The Project Life Cycle is the series of phases through which a project progresses from its beginning to completion. The four phases are: (1) Initiation — identify the need, objectives and major stakeholders; (2) Planning — define scope, schedule, resources and cost; (3) Execution/Implementation — perform the project work while monitoring and controlling progress; and (4) Closure — complete the deliverables, obtain acceptance and formally close the project. Example: In a software project, the requirement is identified during initiation, development is planned, the software is developed during execution, and the final software is delivered and the project is closed.

Easy memory: I → P → E → C = Idea → Plan → Do → Finish.

Bloom/application note: This is BL3-friendly because every phase is applied to a software project instead of merely being listed.

Q2. Differentiate Functional, Projectized and Matrix Organizations.

Feature	Functional	Projectized	Matrix
Authority	Functional manager	Project manager	Shared
Team	Department-based	Dedicated to project	Shared across functions/projects
Reporting	Mainly functional manager	Project manager	Functional + project manager
Main issue	Coordination between departments	Resource duplication	Conflict due to dual authority

Conclusion: Functional emphasizes departments, Projectized emphasizes project control, and Matrix combines both.

Easy memory: F = Functions; P = Project; M = Mix.

Bloom note: A comparison table directly addresses the 'differentiate/compare' requirement.

Q3. Explain the role/skills of a Project Manager.

Exam-ready answer: The Project Manager is the central person responsible for integrating people, tasks and resources to achieve project objectives. Three important skills are: (1) Leadership — guides, motivates and integrates team members toward the project goal; (2) Planning — prepares the roadmap covering activities, resources, schedule and project results; and (3) Conflict Resolution — resolves disagreements between team members or stakeholders so that project work continues smoothly. Other required skills include team building, technical expertise, organization, entrepreneurship, administration, management support and resource allocation.

Easy memory: For three skills: Lead → Plan → Resolve. Full skill list: Team Building, Leadership, Conflict Resolution, Technical Expertise, Planning, Organization, Entrepreneurship, Administration, Management Support, Resource Allocation.

Bloom/application note: The question asks for explanation, so each selected skill has both a meaning and its project-management relevance.

Q4. Explain Systems Approach with an example.

Exam-ready answer: The Systems Approach views a project as a whole system made up of interdependent parts, rather than treating each activity or department separately. It considers inputs, processes, outputs and feedback, along with subsystems, the environment and system boundary. The project manager therefore considers how a decision affects other departments, stakeholders and the external environment. Example: If the production department changes a product specification, it may affect finance, procurement, marketing and the project schedule. Therefore, the PM must consider the impact on the entire project system.

Easy memory: Systems = Whole, not parts. Also remember: Input → Process → Output → Feedback.

Bloom/application note: The example demonstrates application of systems thinking, making the answer suitable for a higher Bloom level.

Q5. Explain SDLC / Systems Development Cycle phases.

Exam-ready answer: The Systems Development Cycle divides the development of a human-made system into four logical phases: (1) Conception — identify the problem or need and develop the basic system concept; (2) Definition — define the requirements, scope and details of the proposed system; (3) Execution — develop, implement and test the system; and (4) Operation — operate, maintain and use the completed system. Example: For a college mobile application, the need is identified in conception, requirements are defined, the application is developed in execution, and the completed application is operated and maintained.

Easy memory: C → D → E → O = Concept → Define → Execute → Operate.

Bloom/application note: Do not confuse this with the Project Life Cycle: Initiation → Planning → Execution → Closure.

Q6. Explain the Six Constraints of Project Management.

Exam-ready answer: The Six Constraint Model considers: (1) Cost — budget available for the project; (2) Risk — uncertainties that may affect project success; (3) Benefits — value expected from the project; (4) Quality — required standard of the project output; (5) Scope — work and deliverables included in the project; and (6) Time — required project completion schedule. These constraints are interconnected, so a change in one constraint can influence project performance in other areas.

Easy memory: Six = Cost + Risk + Benefits + Quality + Scope + Time. Triple = Time + Cost + Scope.

Bloom/application note: The question is BL3 in the assignment, so include the final interrelationship sentence rather than only listing six terms.

Q7. Explain the importance of integration in a large-scale project.

Exam-ready answer: Integration means coordinating and combining different project activities, people and stakeholders so that they work toward a common goal. Integration is especially important in large-scale or mega projects because they involve many parties such as sponsors, contractors, subcontractors, consultants and suppliers. Poor coordination can cause conflicts, delays and cost overruns. Effective integration helps the project achieve its scope, schedule and budget objectives and improves overall project success. Example: In a metro project, government authorities, contractors, engineers and suppliers must coordinate their activities; a delay by one party can affect other activities.

Easy memory: Many people → Many activities → One goal.

Bloom/application note: The answer shows why integration matters and applies it to a realistic mega-project.

Q8. Explain a given quotation in Project Management terms.

Exam-ready answer: Use the following structure for an unfamiliar quotation: (1) state the meaning of the quotation in simple words; (2) connect it to a Project Management concept; (3) give a project example or

application; and (4) state the result or importance. This structure converts a general quotation into a Bloom-oriented project-management answer.

Easy memory: QUOTE → PM CONCEPT → APPLICATION → RESULT.

Bloom/application note: Do not merely explain the quotation generally. Explicitly use project-management terms such as scope, planning, resources, time, cost, control, stakeholders or objectives.

PART C — QUOTATION ANSWERS

Quotation 1: Stephen Covey — “Beginning with the End in Mind.”

Exam-ready answer: The quote means that a project manager should define the desired final outcome before starting the project. In project management, this means clearly defining objectives, scope, deliverables and success criteria before execution. For example, before developing a software application, the PM should determine what the final application must achieve and then plan the required resources, schedule and activities. Thus, a clearly defined end goal provides direction for planning and execution.

Easy memory: End → Objective → Plan → Execute.

Quotation 2: “If you can’t plan it, you can’t do it.”

Exam-ready answer: The quote highlights the importance of planning before execution. In project management, the PM must define the scope, activities, resources, schedule and cost before starting project execution. For example, a bridge project cannot begin effectively without planning its design, materials, manpower, budget and schedule. Therefore, planning converts the desired project outcome into an actionable roadmap and reduces uncertainty during execution.

Easy memory: Plan first → Execute properly.

Quotation 3: “If you can’t measure it, you can’t manage it.”

Exam-ready answer: The quote emphasizes the importance of measurement and control in project management. A PM must measure actual project performance against planned time, cost, scope and performance targets. If a deviation is identified, corrective action can be taken. For example, if a project is only 40% complete when it was planned to be 60% complete, the PM can identify the delay and take corrective action.

Easy memory: Measure → Compare → Correct.

Quotation 4: Frederick Winslow Taylor — management as doing work in the “best and cheapest way.”

Exam-ready answer: The quote emphasizes efficiency and optimum use of resources. In project management, the PM should achieve project objectives using resources such as time, money, manpower and materials efficiently while maintaining the required performance. For example, selecting an appropriate supplier can reduce project cost without compromising project requirements. Thus, the PM aims for the best project result with minimum waste of resources.

Easy memory: Best result + least waste = efficient PM.

Quotation 5: Henri Fayol — “to forecast, to plan, to organize, to command, to co-ordinate and control.”

Exam-ready answer: Fayol's principles can be directly related to project management. Forecast means identifying future requirements; Plan means preparing project activities and schedule; Organize means assigning people and resources; Command means leading the project team; Coordinate means integrating activities and stakeholders; and Control means measuring performance and correcting deviations. Thus, the quotation summarizes major managerial activities required for successful project execution.

Easy memory: Forecast → Plan → Organize → Command → Coordinate → Control.

Quotation 6: James Montgomery Beggs — “The basic principles of project management do not change...”

Exam-ready answer: The quote means that although technology, industries and project environments change, the fundamental principles of project management remain important. A project manager must still focus on planning, organizing, controlling resources, managing constraints and achieving project objectives. Thus, modern tools may change, but the basic principles required to successfully manage a project remain relevant.

Easy memory: Tools change; PM principles remain.

Quotation 7: PMI — project managers use innovation, creativity and collaboration to lead projects that make an impact.

Exam-ready answer: The quotation means that project managers need more than technical knowledge. They must combine goal orientation with innovation, creativity, collaboration and leadership to achieve project objectives. In practice, a PM may need creative solutions to project problems, collaboration among different functional teams and innovation when existing methods are insufficient. These qualities help the PM lead the project toward a successful outcome.

Easy memory: Innovation + Creativity + Collaboration → Impact.

PART D — BONUS HIGH-YIELD QUESTIONS

Q9. Explain a Feasibility Study.

Exam-ready answer: A feasibility study is a systematic evaluation of whether a proposed project is viable and worth undertaking before committing significant resources. It examines whether the project can be technically and economically achieved and whether it can operate successfully within its requirements. Important areas include technical, economic/financial, operational, legal, environmental and schedule feasibility. Example: Before constructing a solar plant, the organization should examine the technology, investment, regulations, environmental impact, operating requirements and completion schedule. If feasibility is poor, the project may be modified, postponed or rejected before major resources are wasted.

Easy memory: Can we build it? → Can we afford it? → Can we operate it?

Q10. Explain Tuckman's stages of team development.

Exam-ready answer: Tuckman's model explains how a project team develops through five stages: (1) Forming — team members come together; (2) Storming — conflicts and disagreements may arise; (3) Norming — members develop cooperation and common norms; (4) Performing — the team works effectively toward project goals; and (5) Adjourning — the project or team comes to an end. The model helps the PM understand team behavior and improve communication, conflict resolution and team performance.

Easy memory: F → S → N → P → A = Form → Storm → Norm → Perform → Adjoin.

PART E — MASTER REVISION SHEET

Topic	Memory trigger
Project	Temporary + Unique + Start/End
Project Management	Plan + Organize + Control → Objective
Triple Constraints	Time + Cost + Scope
Six Constraints	Time + Cost + Scope + Quality + Risk + Benefits
Project Life Cycle	Initiation → Planning → Execution → Closure
Systems Development Cycle	Conception → Definition → Execution → Operation
Systems Approach	Whole system + interdependent parts + feedback
Scope	What is IN + What is OUT
Feasibility	Technical + Economic/Financial + Operational + Legal + Environmental + Schedule
Structures	Functional = Department; Projectized = PM; Matrix = Two bosses
Authority	Can decide
Responsibility	Must do
Accountability	Must answer
Tuckman	Form → Storm → Norm → Perform → Adjoin
Mega Project	Many stakeholders → Integration → One goal
Covey	End → Objective → Plan → Execute
Measure quotation	Measure → Compare → Correct
Taylor	Best + Cheapest → Efficiency
Fayol	Forecast → Plan → Organize → Command → Coordinate → Control
Beggs	Tools change; principles remain

FINAL EXAM WRITING FORMULAS

For 2 marks: Definition + 2/3 precise key points.

For 3 marks: Definition + key points + example/application.

If the question says APPLY: Concept + Situation + How the concept applies/solves the situation.

If the question says ANALYZE: Cause → Effect → Consequence → Project Manager action.

If the question says COMPARE/DIFFERENTIATE: Use a table with 3–4 clear comparison points.

If the question gives a QUOTATION: Meaning → PM concept → Example → Result.

Ultra-Important Distinction

Project Life Cycle: Initiation → Planning → Execution → Closure

Systems Development Cycle: Conception → Definition → Execution → Operation

Exam reminder: If the question is unfamiliar, do not panic. Identify the Bloom verb, state the relevant PM concept, apply it to the situation, and finish with the project outcome/importance. This is safer than trying to reproduce a memorized paragraph that does not answer the exact command in the question.